Where a month of reporting goes.

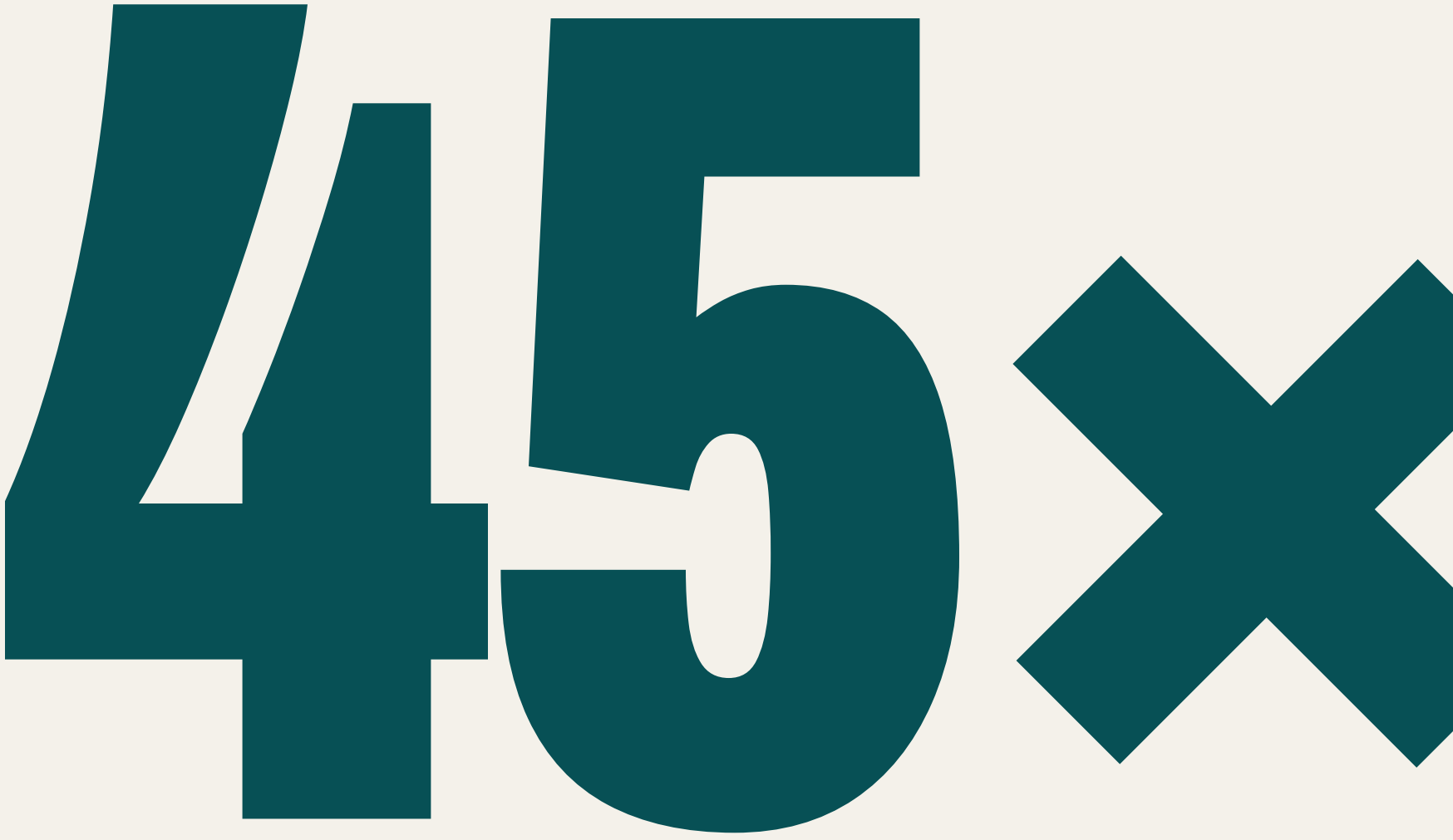
WHEN	ITEM	HOURS
day 1	Export numbers from six tools	6
day 1	Chase the one export that failed	2
day 2	Clean, merge and check by hand	7
	Before anyone reads it	15

Sample content and numbers.

THE MANSIONS AGENCY

The report itself is read in about 20 minutes.

Fifteen hours of assembly for twenty minutes of reading. The ratio is the story, not the report.



Sample numbers: 15 hours of work, 20 minutes of reading.

Two of the fifteen hours are one failed export.

One tool times out on the first try every month. Someone notices on day 1, chases it, and starts again.

WHEN	ITEM	HOURS
09:10	Export fails, nobody told	0
11:40	Missing numbers noticed	1
13:30	Export run again, by hand	1

Sample content.

Same month, two ledgers.

BY HAND

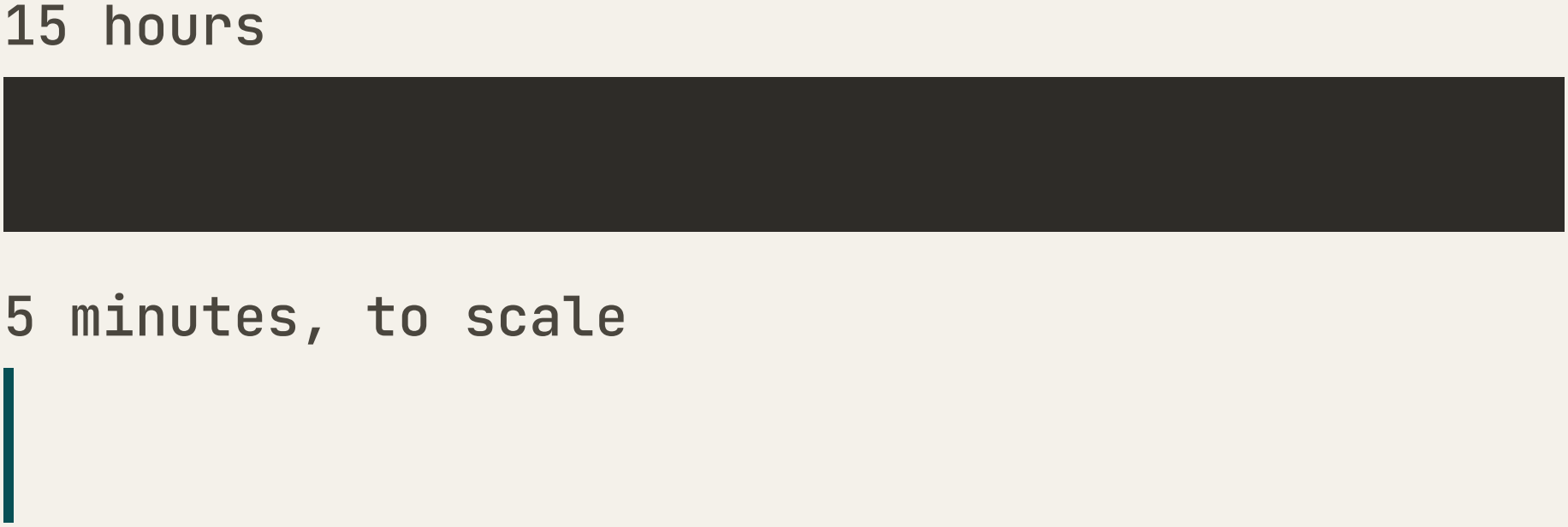
15 h

every month, senior time

AUTOMATED

5 min

a check, then reading



Sample numbers.

What is left after the automation.

WHEN	ITEM	HOURS
day 1	~~Export numbers from six tools~~	~~6~~
day 1	~~Chase the one export that failed~~	~~2~~
day 2	~~Clean, merge and check by hand~~	~~7~~
06:00	**Read the alert if a source fails**	**0.08**

Sample content.

The first check we run: count the hours a person spends moving a number from one screen to another.

That count is usually the cheapest thing to automate, and the first thing nobody misses.